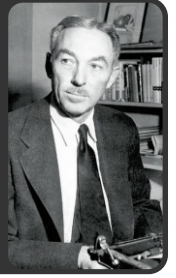


2. ONCE MORE TO THE LAKE

BY E.B WHITE

July 11, 1899 – October 1, 1985

Elwyn Brooks White was an American writer. He was the author of several highly popular books for children, including *Stuart Little*, *Charlotte's Web*, and *The Trumpet of the Swan*. In a 2012 survey of School Library Journal readers, *Charlotte's Web* was ranked first in their poll of the top one hundred children's novels.



EXERCISE 1- POST READING

Q1. Why does writer take a vacation at this particular lake?

Ans: "Once More to the Lake" is written by E. B. White, an American writer. His father took his family to the lake in Maine in 1904 for the first time. They all loved it so much that every August after that they would visit the same lake. He had cherished childhood memories of these visits. Hence, he takes a vacation at this particular lake with his son. He wanted his son to have the similar enjoyment that he had experienced as a child in this natural scenic beauty.

Q2. Which key concerns has the writer expressed in the text?

Ans: On the way to Maine E. B. White wonders about several things. He was greatly concerned about how the time might have spoiled this beautiful unique place. He also thought of what would it be like at that time. He was sure of a tarred road would have found its way then. The same thoughts made him travel back in time and think of all the memories he had of this exceptionally unique natural spot.

Q3. How has the lake changed since he was a boy?

Ans: E. B. White's father used to take his family to the beautiful lake in the city of Maine. They were so mesmerized by the beauty of this natural spot that they would spend every August in the same lake after 1904, their first visit. Mr. White observes many changes when he takes his young son to this place for the first time. The first change was a tarred road that led to within a half mile to the shore. The second was the irritating sound produced by the outboard boats. This sound was so petulant and irritable that spoiled the serene atmosphere of this spot.

Q4. What contrast does the writer make between the sea and lake?

Ans: E. B. White visits this beautiful lake in Maine with his son. He had nostalgic experience as his father used to take them to this heaven on earth every August. He describes his experience of the visit to this natural place a great deal. He also compares this trust worthy lake to a sea. He declares this lake to be enchanted place for even after hours one can find the lake in its own place. Unlike sea water that keeps moving and changing its position.

Q5. Why does writer repeatedly call the lake as 'Wild Lake'?

Ans: E. B. White declares that the lake had never been what you would call a wild lake. In order to emphasize this point he says that there were cottages sprinkled around the shore. It was in farming and the shores were heavily wooded. He says that it is not a place where men cannot reside. Man does not only enjoy the calmness nature of the lake but also settled their cottages to live in the peaceful atmosphere of the lake which is not wild.

Q6. Why is the arriving at the lake less exciting now than in the past?

Ans: E. B. White beautifully makes the comparison between his earlier visits as a child and now when he visits as an adult with his young son. It was less exciting for the author to revisit the lake as time has changed the natural beauty of this spot. This time, he was not as much enthusiastic as before clue to the age difference. Next, the artificiality and noise pollution has also spoiled the natural beauty of the lake. It was no more as peaceful as it was before.

Q7. How are the boat motors different in the present situation?

Ans: E. B. white visits the same lake in Maine where his father used to bring his family in the month of August. He describes this spot of natural beauty and makes a comparison between the lake then and now. In the present situation, the motor boats produce irritable and awful sound now unlike before. Now boats have noisy engines. In the former days, motor were also inboards but now they are outboards.

Q8. The writer calls the lake as a "Holy Spot"? How does he further develop this idea?

Ans: E. B. White has beautifully described the lake in Maine in the light of his visits as a child and as an adult man. The essayist declares the lake as "a holy spot" because it provides him peace and tranquility. He further develops it by explaining it more that it makes him forget the worldly worries and takes him to his beautiful past. It reminds him of his beautiful childhood and helps him forget his mortality.

Q9. What kind of sensation persisted and grew in the mind of the writer?

Ans: "Once More to the Lake" is a creation of E. B. White. Upon visiting the same old lake he began to sustain an illusion that his son was he, by simple transposition, and that he was his father. This sensation persisted, kept cropping up all the time during his stay there. He seemed to be living a dual existence. The same feeling gave him a creepy sensation.

Q10. What is the central idea of the text?

Ans: "Once More to the Lake" is penned down by E. B. White, a famous American writer. Mr. White describes in details his experience of visiting this "holy spot" as a child and as an adult. He makes a comparison and tells how time has changed this natural beauty. He shares his feeling of visiting this place as a young son and later as an adult. He also talks about the impact of developments on nature. His concern of sound pollution is also mentioned here.

EXERCISE 2- MATCH THE FOLLOWING (ANSWERS)

No.	COLUMN A	COLUMN B
1.	marred	spoiled
2.	tarred	Covered with tar
3.	grooves	channel
4.	sneak	secretly
5.	illusion	Wrongly perceived
6.	creepy	Causing fear
7.	moss	Green plant

8.	jollity	happiness
9.	sedative	Causing sleep
10.	petulant	Bad-tempered

EXERCISE 3- MCOS (ANSWERS)

No.	ANSWER	No.	ANSWER
1.	b) son	6.	c) both son and father
2.	d) ordinary man	7.	a) summer
3.	b) calmness	8.	b) lily pads
4.	c) squirrel	9.	b) in Maine
5.	c) happy	10.	a) fishing